

 Strategic Partnership

STACKTIC & SUSE Rancher

The First Truly Managed Open-Source Platform

Speed of managed services. Openness of Kubernetes. Sovereignty by design.

70%+

COST REDUCTION

80%

FASTER DELIVERY

Zero

VENDOR LOCK-IN

100%

SOVEREIGNTY

Together, Stacktic + SUSE Rancher compete head-to-head with managed hyperscaler platforms (**AWS, Azure, GCP**) — without sacrificing control, transparency, or freedom.

The Shared Vision

A unified foundation for enterprise sovereignty

DIMENSION	STACKTIC & SUSE RANCHER
Core Principle	Sovereignty first — customers fully control data, infrastructure, and operations
Platform	Kubernetes-native, open by design
Cloud Model	Cloud-agnostic: public, private, on-prem, edge
Architecture	Multi-cluster by default
Security	Enterprise-grade, policy-driven, automation-first
Regulated Environments	Finance, government, healthcare, critical infrastructure
Air-Gapped & Edge	Fully supported



What is Stacktic?

A **Production Engineering Stack Control System** that automates the entire full-stack lifecycle — architecture, deployment, operations, upgrades, migrations, rollbacks, and compliance — across any Kubernetes environment.

STACKTIC DOES

- ✓ Encode stack logic as metadata
- ✓ Version entire stacks (not just code)
- ✓ Automate Day-0, Day-1, Day-2 ops
- ✓ Remove human & process bottlenecks

STACKTIC IS NOT

- ✗ A PaaS
- ✗ A CI/CD tool
- ✗ A Kubernetes abstraction
- ✗ A developer portal

Clear Role Separation

No overlap, no duplication — clean responsibility boundaries



SUSE Rancher

Infrastructure & Kubernetes Layer

- ✓ Multi-cluster Kubernetes management
- ✓ Cluster lifecycle & access control
- ✓ Curated app catalogs
- ✓ Enterprise Kubernetes foundation

OWNS THE INFRASTRUCTURE



Stacktic

Application & Stack Sovereignty Layer

- ✓ Full-stack relationship automation
- ✓ Metadata-driven versioning & rollbacks
- ✓ Day-2+ ops, migrations, compliance
- ✓ Operational logic encoded as metadata

OWNS THE STACK SOVEREIGNTY

Together: The First Truly Managed Open-Source Platform

Managed like AWS • Open like Kubernetes • Sovereign by design

0

Day 0: Architecture

Hours instead of months

1

Day 1: Deployment

One-click to any Kubernetes

2

Day 2: Operations

Automated ops, security, rollback

Deep Open-Source Automation

What Stacktic uniquely adds to the SUSE Rancher ecosystem

Stacktic automates **relationships and dependencies** across the open-source ecosystem — even when components come from different foundations (CNCF, Apache, Linux Foundation, community OSS).

Understands Relationships

Data flows, security boundaries, APIs, ops dependencies across components

Automates Dependencies

Cross-foundation dependency resolution with version compatibility validation

Policy-Driven Governance

Automatic approval workflows, compliance checks, and audit trails

Validates Upgrades

Checks version compatibility and upgrade paths before execution

Result: Open source that is **stable like a tank** — no broken upgrades, no dependency chaos, no tribal knowledge

Rancher Catalog → Real Stack & Data Pipeline Automation

Stacktic elevates the Rancher App Catalog from isolated Helm installs to relationship-aware stack automation:

Kafka + Connect + MongoDB

Auto-configured connectors

Airflow + Data Sources

Auto-wired pipelines

Observability Stacks

Auto-linked to workloads

Where This Beats OpenShift

✓ Stack-level automation (not cluster-only)

✓ True cloud and vendor neutrality

✓ Metadata-driven intelligence

✓ Open, modular, future-proof architecture

✓ Advanced Day-2 automation incl. human tasks

✓ No proprietary runtime requirements

Key Joint Use Cases

Sovereignty-driven, real-world scenarios



Cluster + Stack Automation

Stacktic automates Rancher-managed clusters as part of the stack definition. Infrastructure decisions are encoded, versioned, and auditable.

Result: Sovereign Kubernetes + sovereign app stack, generated end-to-end



Sovereign Data Pipelines

Automates data source → processing → storage → access control. Proves data never leaves allowed boundaries.

Result: Auditable data residency, flow transparency, access boundaries



Air-Gapped Operations

No SaaS dependency. No external control plane. No runtime internet. Updates via controlled, signed bundles.

Used by: Defense, government, critical infrastructure



Compliance as Code

Stack-level compliance derived from real architecture. Evidence generated automatically, versioned per environment.

Supports: ISO, SOC2, PCI-DSS, HIPAA



Managed-Service Exit Strategy (Board-Level Use Case)

Stacktic provides a credible, executable exit from hyperscaler managed services. Migration is technical, repeatable, and governed — no rewrite, no 6-month planning cycles.

15-30%

Cost Reduction

Zero

Rewrite Needed

Any Cloud

Target

Who This Is For

Two primary audiences with exceptional strategic fit



Regulated & Sovereign Orgs

Finance, Government, Healthcare, Defense

- ✓ Air-gapped & disconnected environments
- ✓ Compliance-ready stacks
- ✓ Private AI / LLM infrastructure
- ✓ Complete data sovereignty

Benefit: Full control with enterprise-grade automation



Enterprises & Platform Teams

Scale-ups, Innovation Labs, App Factories

- ✓ Standardized internal app factories
- ✓ Multi-tenant environments
- ✓ Reduced headcount dependency
- ✓ Ship production in hours, not months

Benefit: Ship faster at a fraction of the cost



Why This Is Strategically Important for SUSE



Rancher

Kubernetes foundation



Stacktic

Logic, automation & sovereignty



Together

Compete with hyperscalers

Feature Comparison vs OpenShift

Head-to-head: where Stacktic + Rancher outperform OpenShift

Container Registry

OpenShift (Quay/OCR)

Integrated but OCR not multi-tenant. Quay requires Operator setup.

Rancher (Harbor)

Enterprise registry with image signing & CVE scanning. Flexible deployment.

Stacktic + Rancher

Integrates with any registry. Automates Harbor and deploys the full stack on it.

App Catalog

OpenShift (OperatorHub)

Managed lifecycle via Operators. Steep learning curve, feels opinionated.

Rancher Apps

Easy Helm installs, SUSE-vetted charts. No Operator lifecycle.

Stacktic + Rancher

Integrates catalog as stack components. Day-2 automation beyond any operator. Automates operators by design.

CI/CD & GitOps

OpenShift (Tekton)

K8s-native but YAML-heavy. Tekton is complex — already failed in VMware Tanzu.

Rancher (Fleet)

Multi-cluster GitOps. CD only, no CI. No built-in GUI pipelines.

Stacktic + Rancher

CI/CD built into the system. Automates any external CI/CD. Multi-cluster GitOps with zero touch.

Build Automation

OpenShift (S2I)

Auto-detect language, no Dockerfile needed. Less flexible than custom builds.

Rancher

No built-in build system. Relies on external tools.

Stacktic + Rancher

Automates builds via Kaniko by default. Supports Buildpacks or any tool — fully open and flexible.

Capabilities OpenShift Can't Match

Stacktic provides full-stack version control including metadata and relationships — something OpenShift lacks entirely

01 360° Automation Framework

Full-stack automation across DataOps, DevOps, SRE, and SecOps

✗ OpenShift: Platform-level only, no relationship automation

02 Knowledge-Centric Automation

Auto-generated documentation and knowledge sharing built into the system

✗ OpenShift: No native knowledge management

03 Security & Compliance Built-In

CISO-grade audit reports generated from stack metadata automatically

✗ OpenShift: Add-on based, not metadata-driven

04 Zero Trust by Default

Auto microsegmentation, multi-layer RBAC, OPA enforcement across the stack

✗ OpenShift: Requires manual security configuration

05 Centralized Stack Control

Manage secrets, versions, and environments at scale from a single source of truth

✗ OpenShift: Cluster-level only, not stack-level

06 Auto Encryption of Everything

SOPs automatically encrypt every secret, removing human error

✗ OpenShift: Manual secret encryption setup

07 Multi-Cluster Stack Automation

Deploy consistent stack logic across multiple clusters with ease

✗ OpenShift: Needs expensive ACM add-on

08 Logical Stack Splitting

Break monoliths into multi-repo, logically separated stacks

✗ OpenShift: No concept of logical stack relationships

09 Intelligent Versioning Engine

Version components with relationship and dependency awareness — no breakage

✗ OpenShift: Isolated versions, no relationship awareness

10 Smart Recommendations & Alerts

Metadata-based suggestions for updates, improvements, and proactive alerts

✗ OpenShift: Metric-based only, no stack intelligence

Value Proposition & Opportunity

Real customer pain points, real solutions, real revenue

CATEGORY	CUSTOMER PAIN	STACKTIC + RANCHER	REVENUE	VS OPENSIFT
 Day 0-2 Automation	Manual processes eat 70% of DevOps time	360° Automation 80% reduction in manual tasks, 10x faster deployments	\$100K-\$1M	Platform-only automation, manual stack mgmt
 Security & Compliance	Failed audits, manual security configs	Automated Zero-Trust 100% encryption, auto-generated compliance reports	\$400K-\$1M	Manual setup, no stack-level awareness
 AIOps	Debugging, log analysis, cost tracking at stack level	Metadata-Driven AIOps Analyzes metadata, Git, and production state intelligently	\$50K-\$350K	No structured data for AI, no AIOps solution
 Multi-Cloud Stack	Managing full stacks across multi clusters	Unified Control Plane Full-stack logic across clusters, one automated system	\$30K-\$300K	No multi-cloud stack-level automation

New Markets Unlocked for SUSE Rancher

 DataOps Pipeline automation	 AI / RAG Private AI stacks	 IDPs Internal dev platforms	 Sovereignty Compliance sectors
--	---	--	---

Stacktic + Rancher can be available **inside Rancher as a private SaaS** or as an external SaaS — delivering full-stack automation capabilities **unmatched in the industry**

The Bottom Line

Rancher provides the **Kubernetes foundation**. Stacktic provides the **logic, automation, and sovereignty stack layer**.

Together, they create the first Managed Open-Source Platform

That can compete head-to-head with managed hyperscaler services — without sacrificing control, transparency, or future freedom.

Joint Architecture Overview

APPLICATION & STACK LAYER (STACKTIC)

Stack Versioning • Relationship Engine • Day 0-2 Automation • Compliance



KUBERNETES MANAGEMENT (SUSE RANCHER)

Multi-Cluster • Lifecycle Mgmt • Access Control • App Catalog



INFRASTRUCTURE

 AWS  Azure  GCP  On-Prem  Edge  Air-Gap

Next Steps

Enterprise-grade open source, fully automated, sovereign by design.

[Schedule Joint Briefing](#)[Request Architecture Review](#)

© 2026 Stacktic & SUSE

Enterprise-grade open source, fully automated, sovereign by design.